

3-room apartment — Cedar Quarter, Northbridge

18 Aurora Lane, Cedar Quarter, Northbridge

€162,000

Asking price

+3.5% vs market

€156,500

Estimated fair value

Fictional showcase property for the public demo report

Surface

82 m²

Rooms

3

Floor

4/6

Condition

Ready to move in

Year built

2014

Energy class

B

8.1_{/10}

Price score
= Stable

8.7_{/10}

Area score
+ Up

7.4_{/10}

Investment potential
+ Up

1.8_{/10}

Legal risk
= Stable

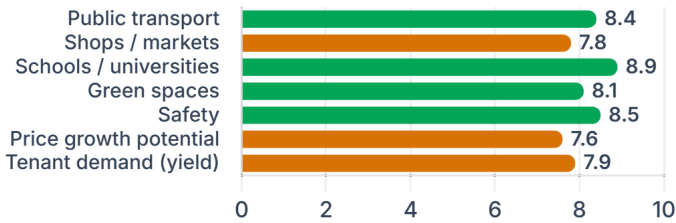
2.1_{/10}

Structural risk
= Stable

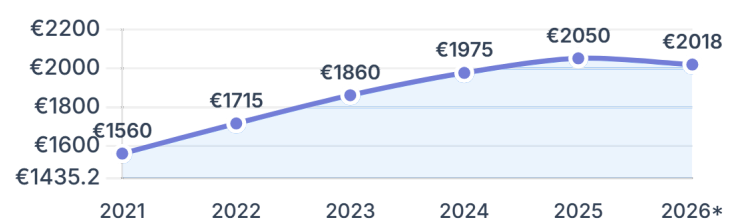
8.3_{/10}

Overall score
+ Up

Neighborhood amenities score



Price per sqm trend in Cedar Quarter (last 5 years)



Environmental indicators

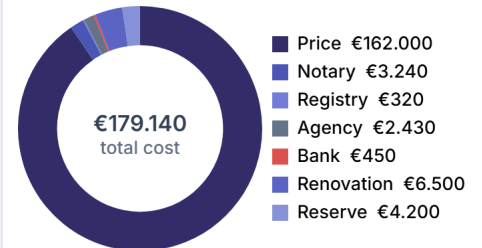
41 AQI — Good

Air quality	Good
Noise	Moderate (44 dB)
Green spaces	52%
Pollution sources	Secondary road traffic
Walkability	Very good (82/100)

Property profile



Total acquisition cost (not just the list price)



E Energy class: **C** — average costs

! Seismic risk: **Class II (moderate)**

S Land registry encumbrances: **None identified**

R Cadastral status: **Registered**

U Elevator: **Present**

P Parking: **Underground space included**

7.8_{/10}

Final recommendation

BUY WITH NEGOTIATION

Solid property in a premium area — the asking price is overpriced by ~7%, but the area and investment potential justify the interest.

Ideal for

- Family with 1–2 children looking for a quiet area and good schools
- Real estate investor looking for rental yield
- Person who works remotely and values quiet and green space

Not recommended

- Buyer with a fixed budget who cannot negotiate the price
- Someone who wants a move-in-ready home without additional investment
- Person sensitive to seismic risk (1972 building, class II)



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Acest raport este generat pe baza datelor publice disponibile din piață și a analizelor comparative statistice.

The listed price is above the estimated fair value, and the full cost of entry significantly exceeds the price shown in the ad. The property remains interesting, but only with a clear negotiation strategy and a realistic budget for related costs.

Value and total cost

The roughly 10,000 EUR gap between the asking price and fair value is not dramatic for a premium area, but it becomes relevant when you add transaction fees, any commission, and the costs of bringing the property up to standard. From a disciplined buyer's perspective, the decision should not be only about the list price, but about the total amount tied up in the first 6–12 months.

Asking price	148,000 EUR	Fair value	138,000 EUR
Difference	10,000 EUR	Overpricing	7.2 %

At this price level, every 1% negotiated means roughly 1,480 EUR saved immediately.

Administrative costs are small relative to the price, but technical costs can vary a lot after a detailed viewing.

If the plan is to hold for 7+ years, the entry gap is more easily absorbed through appreciation of the area.

If the plan is a quick resale (under 3 years), entering at a price close to fair value becomes critical.

Cost	Amount	Mandatory
Transaction fees <i>Notary + registration, standard estimate</i>	€3,256	Yes
Agency commission <i>Can be negotiated or removed depending on the deal</i>	€2,220	Optional
Renovation + reserve <i>For functional updates + contingency margin</i>	€11,000	Optional
Estimated acquisition total	€164,826	

Mortgage and negotiation

The difference between scenarios is not only about the monthly payment, but about long-term financial flexibility. In practice, a larger down payment reduces monthly pressure and the risk of financial stress in years with volatile interest rates. Negotiation should be done with concrete arguments, not just a generic request for a discount.

If the bank values the property below the negotiated price, the difference must be covered from your own funds.

A larger down payment can increase your negotiating power with the seller (safer transaction).

Before the final offer, validate the renovation estimate with 1–2 real quotes from contractors.

Target price: €138,000

- Open with an initial offer of 136,000–138,000 EUR, supported by recent comparable prices per sqm and the construction year.
- Use the cost-to-standard argument (renovation + reserve), not only the theoretical market gap.
- Condition the final offer on technical and legal verification, with a withdrawal clause in case of non-compliance.
- Negotiate auxiliary elements separately: handover date, remaining furniture, commission, any remedial works before signing.

Illustrative scenarios, 25 years, 6.8%. Includes a stress test at +1 percentage point interest.



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25% down payment

€37,000 Down payment	€688 Monthly payment	€111,000 Loan	€206,600 Total cost
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Minimum recommended income: 3,440 EUR/month

35% down payment

€51,800 Down payment	€597 Monthly payment	€96,200 Loan	€179,300 Total cost
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Minimum recommended income: 2,985 EUR/month

Recommended actions

- Request 3 sold comparables from the last 6–9 months nearby, not just active listings.
- Prepare a separate budget for transaction and post-acquisition costs so you do not consume the down payment.
- Set your maximum acceptable price (walk-away price) from the start and do not cross it under pressure.

Area and access

3/5

Cedar Quarter remains one of the strongest residential areas in Northbridge, with steady demand, short absorption time, and a strong profile both for living and for premium rentals.

Core area indicators

The quality of the area is this property's main asset. Good safety, proximity to the center, and the service mix reduce vacancy risk for rentals and support liquidity on resale. For buyers seeking stability, the area partially offsets the technical disadvantages of the older building.

Safety	9 /10	Quietness	8.5 /10
City center (walking)	15 min	Transport stop	4 min
Public transport	Yes	Frequency	8 min
City center by bus	7 min	City center on foot	15 min
Parking	underground included	Bicycle	Yes — Dedicated lanes

27385

5-year growth	+43.7%	Average annual growth	6.8%
Average days on market	18 days	Vacancy rate	2.1%
Demand / supply			3.2 inquiries / listing

Local mobility upgrades and private investment in nearby services

- Good school 8 min away 8 min
- UBB 12 min away 12 min
- Supermarket 6 min away 6 min
- Park 7 min away 7 min

Positive factors:

- Steady residential demand from families and professionals with above-average incomes.
- Proximity to the center preserves attractiveness even in slower market scenarios.
- Limited supply in the area supports prices and short selling times.

Risk factors:

- Entry prices are already high, which can reduce the room for negotiation.
- Over short periods, liquidity may fall if interest rates rise sharply.

What the area means for day-to-day living

For owner-occupancy, the area scores well on the balance between access and quiet. For investment, the key criterion is that you can simultaneously target two solid segments: families seeking stability and corporate tenants prioritizing location. That reduces the risk of dependence on a single demand type.

- Travel time to central points is predictable both on foot and by public transport.
- Educational and retail amenities increase the appeal for medium- and long-term rentals.
- The area profile favors more stable tenants, with lower turnover and lower non-payment risk.
- In the final decision, the area is a strong argument for long-term holding.

Recommended actions

- Visit at two different times of day (morning/evening) to validate real noise and traffic.
- Check on site the stated distances to schools, transport, and essential services.
- Compare the area with 1–2 similar micro-areas to validate whether the premium is justified.

Investment potential

Good medium- to long-term investment profile, supported by rental demand and the area's historical appreciation. Net yield is solid for a premium residential asset, but it depends on entering at the right price.

Yield and value scenarios

At an estimated rent of 750 EUR/month, the property produces a gross yield above the average of many premium areas in major cities. Net yield remains reasonable after recurring costs, and the estimated average occupancy time is favorable. The biggest variable remains the acquisition price: every negotiated reduction directly increases the yield.

- Entering at 138,000 EUR instead of 148,000 EUR immediately increases yield and reduces exit risk.
- In the moderate scenario, the asset keeps a good defensive profile for a 10-year portfolio.
- In adverse scenarios, area quality helps maintain occupancy and limit rent discounts.

Estimated rent (furnished)	€750 /month	Estimated rent (unfurnished)	€0 /month
Gross yield	6.08%	Net yield	4.9%
Annual net income	€7,290	Days to rent	8 days
Breakeven	13.2 years	Tenant demand	High

Moderate (+3%/an)

€197,020

Value 2036

+€49,020

Total gain

+33.1%

Growth

Stable demand in a premium area and limited residential supply

Optimistic (+5%/an)

€241,120

Value 2036

+€93,120

Total gain

+62.9%

Growth

Falling interest rates + expansion of the high-income buyer segment

Total buying cost (10 years)

€164,826

Total rent (10 years)

€90,000

Property value 2036

€197,020

Net buying position

+€108,620

Buying advantage vs rent (10 years)

+€198,620

Illustrative simulation. Does not include interest-rate shocks, extended vacancy periods, or major structural repair costs.

High-impact improvements

Selective interventions can increase both resale value and potential rent without a costly full renovation. The optimal strategy is efficient capital allocation: small, visible investments with fast impact on buyer and tenant perception.

Prioritize visible and functional finishes, not cosmetic works with no practical use.

Use durable materials to reduce maintenance costs in the first 3–5 years.

Document all works with invoices and photos for added resale value.

Improvement

Cost

+ Value

ROI

+ Rent/month

Bathroom renovation High impact on the rental decision

€3,500

€6,000

+71%

+€50

Kitchen upgrade Improves appeal to stable tenants

€2,500

€4,500

+80%

+€40

Recommended actions

- Calculate net yield under 3 rent scenarios: prudent, moderate, optimistic.
- Include in the model an annual maintenance reserve of at least 1–1.5% of the asset value.
- Decide in advance on the main strategy: owner-occupancy, long-term rental, or mix.



Conclusion and due diligence

5/5

BUY WITH NEGOTIATION: good property in an excellent area, provided you enter at a disciplined price and complete all checks before signing.

Final verdict

The total score reflects a strong asset on location and potential, with two points that require attention: the entry price and the technical verification for the older building. In practical terms, the decision is favorable if you secure real negotiation and close the critical risks before the pre-contract.



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Main pro argument: very liquid area, with a good track record of appreciation.

Main con argument: entering at too high a price reduces yield and margin of safety.

Operational conclusion: good transaction only if checks and negotiation are executed strictly.

7.8_{/10}

Overall score

BUY WITH NEGOTIATION

6.8

Price

Weight: 20%

9.1

Area

Weight: 25%

7.6

Investment

Weight: 20%

9

Legal

Weight: 20%

6.2

Structure

Weight: 15%

Mandatory minimum checks

These checks are not optional. They separate a good acquisition from a costly long-term problem. It is recommended to have both a legal filter (notary/lawyer) and a technical filter (inspector/engineer).

Updated land registry excerpt

Encumbrances, restrictions, litigation, ownership match
Demo Market Registry/notary on document preparation day

critical

Ownership documents + ID

Clear ownership chain and data matching the land registry
Notarial review and comparison with original documents

critical

Energy certificate + homeowners' association status

Outstanding debts, atypical consumption, real technical data
Direct request from the seller and building manager

important

☐ Structural cracks, settlement, infiltration

Load-bearing walls, corners, ceiling, bathroom area

high

☐ Electrical installation and panel

Wear level, grounding, available capacity

medium

☐ Heating and water installation

Pressure, leak traces, radiators, boiler

medium

Signal: Refusal to provide land registry excerpt or key documents

Action: Stop the transaction until there is complete clarification.

Signal: Pressure to sign quickly without checks

Action: Do not sign under pressure; maintain the contractual conditions.

Signal: Differences between documents, statements, and site reality

Action: Request official rectification before any advance payment.



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| Next steps

The right order of steps protects your budget and your time. In practice, the most common mistake is entering final negotiation before closing the critical risks.

1 Action: Detailed technical viewing + photo checklist

Timeline: Immediately **urgent**

2 Action: Complete legal checks and document validation

Timeline: Before final offer **critical**

3 Action: Final negotiation in the 136k–141k EUR range

Timeline: After validations **urgent**

4 Action: Phased renovation plan + contingency budget

Timeline: Pre-signing **important**

Recommended actions

- Do not pay an advance without an explicit withdrawal clause if checks uncover major non-compliance.
- Include clear deadlines in the pre-contract for documents, handover, and any agreed remedial works.
- Keep a liquidity reserve after acquisition for the first 6 months of unexpected expenses.



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